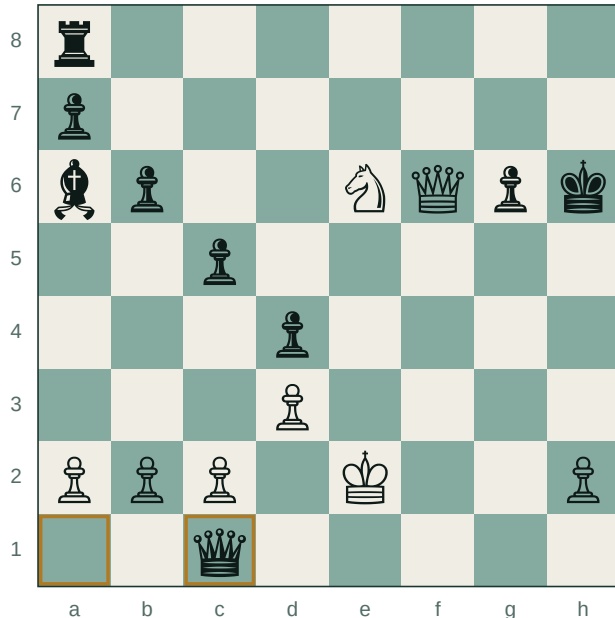


# Anastasia mating nets: White, move 40

Anastasia mating nets

White to move



Previous move: 39...Qc1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

## 40. Qh4#

**40.Qh4#** Mate: queen on h4 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h6. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

### CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on h4. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

### CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The knight is often a supporting piece rather than the final checker. Do not overlook its quiet control of escape squares.

### WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An Anastasia-type net uses a knight to restrict king escapes while a rook or queen checks along an edge file. Removing a pawn shield can be the crucial preparation.

### HOW TO LOOK

Locate the knight's controlled flight squares and the heavy piece's checking line. Follow how the combination opens that line.

The defending king is on h6. Absolute pin: pawn on g6.